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El Paso Herald-Post (El Paso, Texas) · Tue, Mar 25, 1969 · Page 18
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Astro Suit First One in Baseball

They Blast Ruling In Expo Trade

HOUSTON (UPI) — The Houston Astros, who lost their best hitter, Rusty Staub, in a ruling by the baseball commissioner last Friday, filed a precedent-setting suit in federal court to get him back from the Montreal Expos.

A spokesman for the Astros said he thought it was the first time in baseball history one club had sued another.

THE ASTROS asked U.S. Dist. Judge John V. Singleton Jr. to cancel the trade which sent Staub from Houston to Montreal for first baseman Donn Clendenon and outfielder Jesus Alou.

The Astros claim the trade was void after Clendenon retired earlier this month. They cited 12 of the major league baseball rules which deals with a traded player retiring before reporting to his new team.

BUT COMMISSIONER Bowie Kuhn ruled Staub belonged to the Expos and the Astros should keep Alou and receive another player. He said he would pick the other player if the Astros and Expos do not agree on one by Wednesday.

General Manager H. B. (Spec) Richardson of the Astros said this was forcing a trade on Houston. He wanted to know why rule 12F did not apply, but Kuhn would not answer any questions. He said his decision was in the "best interests of baseball."

"Maybe we can get the commissioner's answer in court," Richardson said.

JUDGE ROY Hofheinz, Astros owner, said in Florida that Kuhn's decision could wreck the reserve clause system, which allows a team to control a player and prevents players negotiating with another team.

Hofheinz apparently meant Clendenon was trying to pick the team he wanted to play for—Atlanta—and if the players start choosing their teams, the clause would be useless.

There have been reports that Clendenon, who became vice president of a pen company based in Atlanta, would play for the Braves. He denied this. Under Kuhn's ruling, the Expos could trade Clendenon to the Braves and he could come out of retirement and play this season.

151 Fans See Mavs Play

United Press International

There are 151 die-hard Houston fans who still believe in the Mavericks.

The last place Mavs drew the handful of loyal supporters last night to watch them wallop second place Denver 124-115 in a Western Division game.

Houston allowed Denver the honor of leading at halftime 62-61 and then rallied for the victory in the only American basketball association game played.

Bob Verga netted 26 points for the winning Mavs. Lavern Tart and Lonnie Wright paced Denver with 22 points apiece.

Campestre Slates Meet

The Campestre Juarez Golf Course will hold a Medal Play 36 Holes Tournament April 5-6.

There will be flights A, B and C with golf merchandise awarded as trophies.

For further information, contact Ruben Ramirez at 533-0658 in El Paso.

Bowling

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FORM CHARTS

12–Seattle, AL West

By MARTY RALBOVSKY, NEA Sports Writer

Davis

PROSPECTUS—The Pilots came out of the expansion draft much better than the other new clubs and should have the best record among the expansionists. The pitching staff is accentuated by Yankee retreads, but the rest of the club has some established performers, such as Tommy Davis, Ray Oyler, Don Mincher and Rich Rollins. Joe Schultz' Pilots won't be spectacular, but representative at least.

PITCHING—Some old ex-Yankees—Steve Barber, Jim Bouton, Roland Sheldon and Bill Stafford—will get comeback chances. Barber and Bouton are most likely to stick. Jack Aker, Gary Bell and Diego Segui are other vets who could win jobs. Rating: C.

CATCHING—Gerry McNertney from White Sox and Larry Haney from Orioles will be battling for starting job. Neither hits for average. Rating: C—.

INFIELD—Mincher from Angels will open at first base, but Mike Hogan, once a highly regarded Yankee Prospect, also figures. Chico Salmon from Indians has inside track at second; while Oyler from Tigers will open at short and Rollins from Twins at third. Mike Ferraro, another ex-Yankee, has has outside chance at third. Rating: C+.

OUTFIELD—Davis, back on the West Coast after a stint with the White Sox, still hasn't regained the batting eye he once had when winning back-to-back NL average titles. Tommy Harper and Jose Vidal, ex-Indians, could flank Davis in left and right, respectively. Rating: C.

ROOKIES TO WATCH—Outfielder Wayne Comer, up from Toledo, and young lefty Gary Timberlake, up from Fort Lauderdale, will get long looks.

Predicted Finish: 6th in West.

(Newspaper Enterprise Assn.)

13–Atlanta, NL East

Aaron

Harris

PROSPECTUS—Young pitching staff showed promise last season, but must do even better to stop St. Louis in NL's Eastern Division. Return of Rico Carty (out last season with tuberculosis) should bolster hitting attack, which will be even more productive this season with the fences at Atlanta Stadium moved in. If pitching comes through, Lum Harris' team'll give Cards run.

PITCHING—Pat Jarvis (16-12), Phil Niekro (14-12) and Ron Reed (11-10) are young and fast. They are capable of improving records this season. Milt Pappas will be around for a full season and will help. Ken Johnson (5-8), and Jim Britton (4-6) need better seasons. Rating: B.

CATCHING— Joe Torre was traded. He hit .271 last season, but home run production tailed off to 10. Bob Tillman spells him. Rating: B+.

INFIELD—Return of healthy Sonny Jackson will strengthen infield. He missed considerable time last season because of leg injuries and batted only .226. When healthy, he's one of NL's most promising shortstops. Orlando Cepeda has glove, but no bat. So does Clete Boyer (both hit in low .200s last season). Felix Millan (.289) will start somewhere and so might Bob Johnson (.262). Rating: C.

OUTFIELD—Hank Aaron (right), Felipe Alou (center) and Carty (left) give Braves strong outfield. Carty is only question mark. Tito Francona will step in is Carty isn't ready. Rating: A.

ROOKIES TO WATCH—Braves want look at pitcher Stan Bell (9-1 at Greenwood) and outfielder Ralph Garr (.293 at Shreveport).

Predicted Finish: 2nd in East.

(Newspaper Enterprise Assn.)

Box Scores In the ABA

Denver (115)	G	F	T	Houston (124)	G	F	T
Wilburn	0	0-0	0	Bunce	2	0-0	4
Hammond	9	2-2	20	Becker	1	2-2	4
Tiatowski	9	1-1	20	Swagerty	9	4-6	22
Beck	6	5-5	17	Kramer	3	10-12	16
Congdon	2	1-1	5	Verga	9	8-10	26
Tart	8	6-7	22	Rhine	5	4-6	14
McGill	4	0-1	8	Johnson	8	4-5	20
Simmons	0	1-3	1	Jackson	5	7-8	18
Wright	10	2-4	22				
Totals	48	18-25	115	Totals	42	39-49	124

DENVER .... 28 34 26 27—115
HOUSTON .... 29 32 34 29—124
Total Fouls: Denver 32, Houston 24.
Three-Point Plays: Jackson, Tiatowski.
A—151.

Ascarate Golf Slates Meeting

Ascarate Golf Assn. will hold its first general meeting of the year tomorrow at 7:30 p.m. at the clubhouse. A movie featuring Gary Player wil be shown.

Non members are also invited.

Aggies Win

COLLEGE STATION (UPI) —Texas A & M upended Southern Methodist 5½ to ½ in a golf match.

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Denver Wins Opener

Wildness Handicap To Miners

By MIKE PEMBERTON

Andy Cohen worried about a control problem in the pitching of his U.T. El Paso Miners today as they faced the Denver University Pioneers in the second game of a series at Dudley Field.

Lefty Lynn Hunt couldn't find the plate very well and the Miners lost the first game of the Denver series yesterday 8-5.

COHEN SAID, "Hunt had good stuff but he couldn't get the ball over when he had to. Two other things hurt us. We didn't hit very well and those errors stopped us from making some fielding plays." The Miners errored five times.

Coach Jack Rose of Denver said, "Hunt threw well except for the fact that he couldnt keep his fast ball low. We took advantage of that."

HUNT, RETURNING to the mound after a week's layoff, got in trouble at the start. Although it was the third inning before Denver got its first hit, the Pioneers had men on base all three innings via walks and errors.

THE MINERS got on the board with five big runs in the bottom of third inning. But the Pioneers came right back in the top of the fourth inning and put three to their side.

"When we came back and got those three runs it was the turning point in the game for us," said Rose. "This showed the boys they could come back and win."

The big men at the plate for Denver were Gary Lay and Dennis Turner. Lay went three for five at the bat which included a double and three RBI's, and Turner was three for four with a double and two RBI's.

FOR THE MINERS were limited to four hits by Denver pitcher Steve Foran. Bob Morales collected two of those hits three times at bat.

Foran went the distance for the Pioneers striking out five of the Miner batters.

DENVER	ab	r	h	bi	UTEP	ab	r	h	bi
Lay 2b	5	0	3	3	Sandoval 2b	4	1	0	0
Crandall rf	6	0	1	1	Murphy rf	4	1	1	2
Kroll cf	3	0	0	0	Blanco 3b	4	1	1	1
Saluato 3b	5	1	0	0	Hix c	4	0	0	0
Parker 1b	5	1	2	0	Butler lf	2	1	0	0
Hocker c	5	1	1	1	Miller 1b	4	0	0	0
Foran p	5	2	1	0	Ward cf	4	0	0	2
Kachurka ss	2	2	1	0	Morales ss	3	1	2	0
Saunders c	1	0	0	0	Hunt p	2	0	0	0
Turner lf	4	1	3	2	Milner p	0	0	0	0
					Robinson ph	1	0	0	0
					Foster ph	1	0	0	0
Totals	41	8	12	8	Totals	33	5	4	4

		R	H	E
DENVER	000 301 202—	8	12	4
UTEP	005 000 000—	5	4	5

DP—Blanco-Hix-Miller, Blanco-Sandoval-Miller, Blanco-Sandoval-Miller; Kochurka-Lay-Parker. LOB—UTEP 5, Denver 12. 3B—Murphy. SB—Parker, Blanco, Morales. S—Milner.

	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO
Foran, W (2-0)	9	5	4	3	3	5
Hunt	5	7	4	4	5	1
Milner, L (2-2)	3⅓	6	4	1	1	2
Peterson	⅔	0	0	0	0	0

U—Pritchard and Rosas. T—2:30.

NHL Standings

East	W	L	T	Pts.	GF	GA
Montreal	45	17	11	101	259	187
Boston	41	17	15	97	291	210
New York	39	25	8	86	216	185
Toronto	33	24	15	81	222	203
Detroit	33	29	11	77	231	207
Chicago	32	33	8	72	264	236

West	W	L	T	Pts.	GF	GA
St. Louis	35	25	14	84	196	133
Oakland	28	35	11	67	209	244
Philadelphia	19	34	20	58	166	238
Los Angeles	24	39	9	57	135	242
Minnesota	18	41	14	50	183	257
Pittsburgh	17	45	10	44	173	243

Last Night's Results
(No games scheduled).
Tonight's Games
Pittsburgh at Minnesota.
(Only Game Scheduled).

For Mile, Relay Team in Californa Meet

Vandy Undecided

Some guys have a tough time making a decision on which shoe lace to tie first. There are individuals who couldn't make a hurried decision if one put lighted matches under their fingernails.

In some cases, Wayne Vandenburg, the young track coach at Texas-El Paso, fits into this classification. Vandy can rattle off the school and stadium records at Minerland quicker than a hippie will use the back door of a barber shop.

HOWEVER, HE often has trouble telling you who will be members of his mile relay or what three guys will be entered in the mile run Saturday night at Kidd Field when his Miners host University of California in a dual meet.

Take the mile relay, for example. The foursome of Jesse Gonzalez, Chris Fisher, Perry Jones and Dan Tague ripped off a 3:16.8 at Tempe last Saturday night as the Miners whipped BYU and Arizona State in a triangular meet.

While filling out his entry list for the same event for Saturday night, Vandenburg has more trouble. He lists not only Gonzalez, Perry, Jones and Tague but also has added the names of Mike Fray and Les Miller.

"I'LL KNOW by event time Saturday night," Vandy explains when pressed for his starting foursome.

Ditto for the mile run.

At Tempe he used Pete Romero, Dan McKillip, Rod Hill and Kerry Ellison. In a dual meet, only three entrants from each school will be allowed.

BAHAMAS ACE—Les Miller is one of the four aces on the U.T. El Paso track team. He's a 440-yard man, long jumper, and triple jumper, and runs on the mile relay team.

What does Vandy have on his entry list as possible performers in the mile run? Only seven names.

SEVEN. Count 'em. Kerry Pearce, Fisher, Romero, Hill, Ellison, Richard Caughey and Bill DeFusco.

"I have no idea, right now, who I'll use Saturday night, babes," Vandy says. "I'll know by Saturday night as the event approaches."

Romero did the mile at Tempe in 4:11.6, his best of the spring, to place second behind BYU's Stan Bergeson, who finished with a 4:11 flat. McKillip was third, 4:12.4, and Hill was fourth, 4:14. Ellison was fifth in the event.

CALIFORNIA'S BEST bet in the mile run, no doubt, will be Jerry Tallon who has a season bet of 4:10.1 while Dennis Barley has cruised the four lap oval in 4:15.6.

California's mile relay team, which has a best of 3:15.8, is composed of Bob McLennan, Clarence Johnson, Randy Smyth and Jim Smith.

While the Miners were destroying both BYU and Arizona Stae last weekend, California was finishing second behind Southern California, in the Easter Relays at Santa Barbara.

Terry Funk, The Lawman In Mat Bout

Terry Funk, fresh off a win over Buddy Colt in semi-final action in International City Wrestling Club's weekly card in the Coliseum last night, will be joined by the Lawman to face the Infernos in the headliner of next week's card.

The Lawman, from Abilene, will be making his first appearence in El Paso. He is the man who put J. C. Dykes, The Infernos' irrepressible manager, in the hospital for several weeks recently.

FUNK USED the reliable Funk family spinning toe-hold to fasion the first fall over Colt last night. Colt evened the count with a knee drop off the top rope, but young Funk came back to wrap it up with a cradle hold.

The Japanese team of Chanti Yokouchi and Mr. Ito was held to a rare draw with Ricky Romero and Jerry Kozak in main event action as time ran out with the teams even at a fall apiece.

Gorgeous George was disqualified and Chief Little Eagle declared the winner of a special one-fall fray when George tried to utilize the sash of his entry robe to strangle the Indian.

Rolando Robles measured Ceasar Velasco in the opener.

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Goes to Miami—

Pats Star Says Okay On Trade

By WARREN CARLSON

BOSTON (UPI)—Not long ago Nick Buoniconti said publicly that there were only three members of the Boston Patriots who would be worth anything on the trading block and he was one of them.

Today, under Buoniconti's estimates, there are only two.

The veteran linebacker from Notre Dame who spent seven years with the Boston entry in the American Football League was traded to the Miami Dolphins for rookie quarterback Kim Hammond, linebacker John Bramlett and an undisclosed draft choice.

"WHAT CAN I say about being traded? I've spent seven wonderful years with a great club," Buoniconti said from his Randoph home.

"I guess coach (Clive) Rush figured he needed a quarterback and since Boston doesn't have linebacker trouble, I was expendable," he said.

The 29-year-old Buoniconti, who was just about everybody's all-league middle linebacker during five of his seven-year Boston career, said he hadn't talked to any Dolphin officials as yet, but said, "if I've got to be traded I can't think of a better team to go to than Miami. They're going to be one great club. They're young, aggressive and will really be giving some competition."

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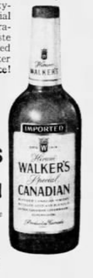

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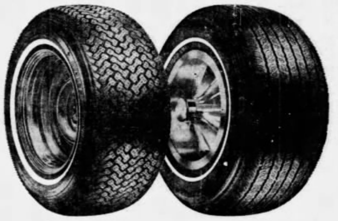

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